

●●● Fisk-Vanderbilt Master's-to-PhD Bridge Program

Navigating Academic Relationships in a Graduate Program



VANDERBILT UNIVERSITY
Graduate School
Graduate and Postdoc Academic Success Program

What is The Graduate & Postdoc Academic Success Program (GPAS)?



<https://gradschool.vanderbilt.edu/gpas/>
@VU_GPAS

CONSIDER A CONSULTATION, IF YOU NEED:

Someone to listen to and have a discussion with about your concern

Strategies for better productivity and/or progress, including goal setting, time management and prioritizing

Knowledge of and assistance accessing resources available to graduate students and postdocs on campus

Assistance working through an issue with a colleague, advisor or supervisor

Clarification concerning a university, departmental or program policy

To explore the formal options available for addressing your concern

Your Graduate & Postdoc Academic Success Team



STACEY SATCHELL, MA, MS

Director, GPAS
ICF Professional Certified Coach
CliftonStrengths Certified Coach

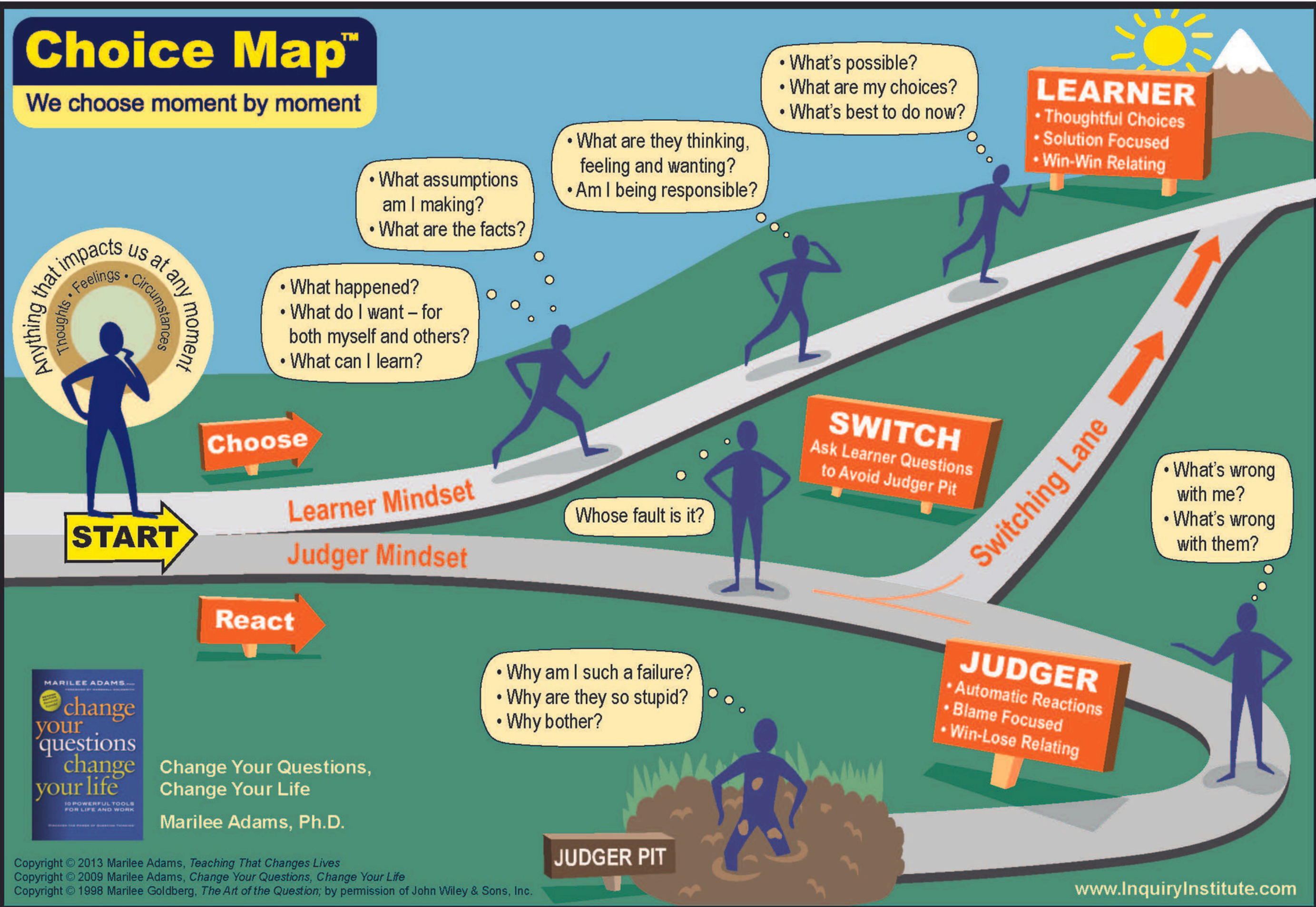


NICK HYER, MS

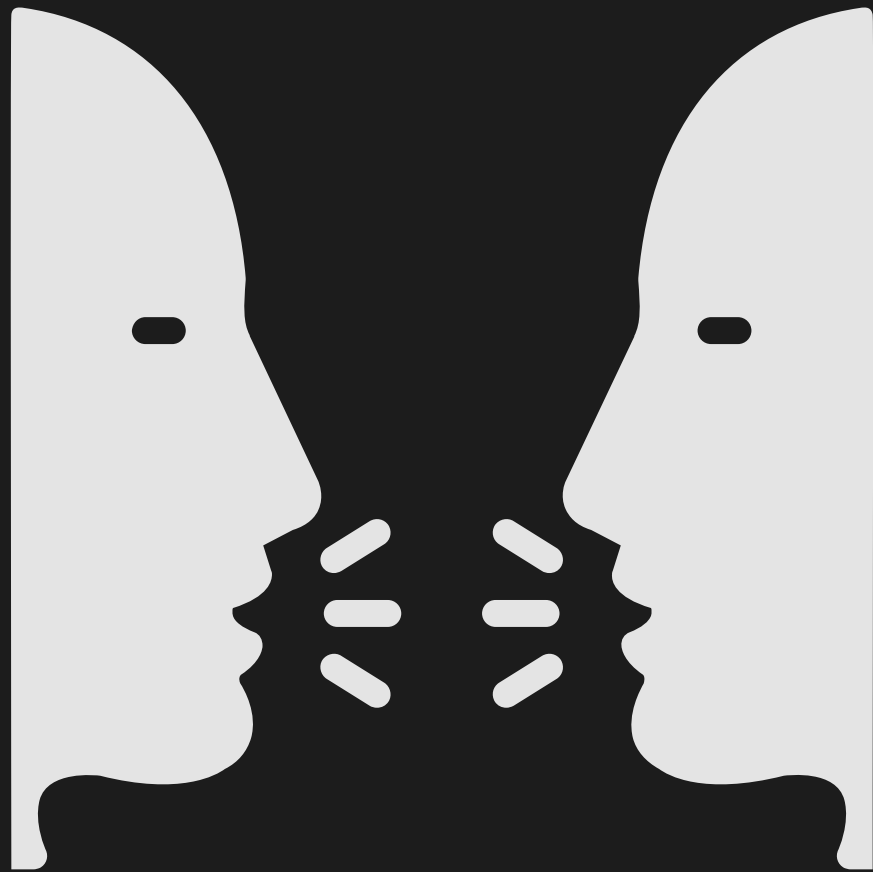
Academic Success Coordinator,
CliftonStrengths Certified Coach
Design Your Life Coach

Choice Map™

We choose moment by moment



purpose for today



This session will focus on navigating academic relationships during your time in graduate school (and beyond). There will be a particular emphasis on how to have conversations about expectations and set appropriate boundaries.

reflecting on your mentoring relationship

- What seems to be working well for you in the mentor-trainee relationship?
- What is not working so well for you? What might you do differently?
- Did you set goals/expectations with your mentor at the beginning of your academic relationship?
- What aspects of mentoring do you need to get from someone other than your direct mentor? Who can provide this mentoring?



...

**“Clear is kind, unclear is unkind.
Stop -stop avoiding the tough
conversations because you think
you’re being polite or kind to
people –that’s not kind.”**

BRENÉ BROWN, PHD



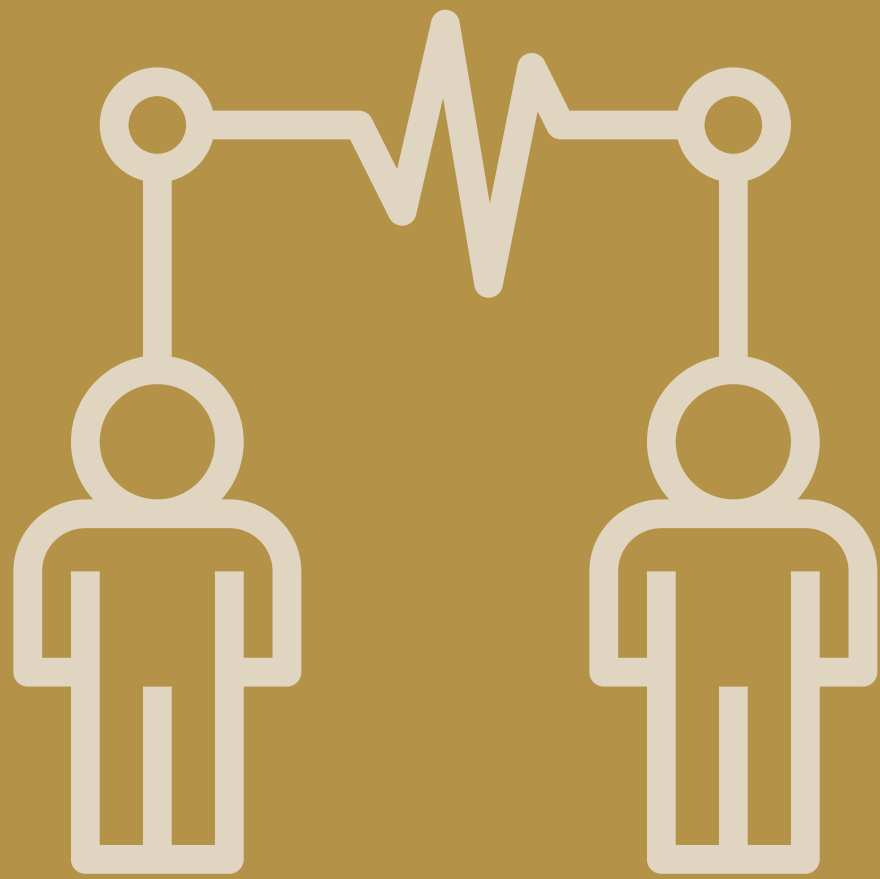


Navigating Academic Relationships

- Communication
- Managing Expectations
- Managing Up
- Mentor Network

Managing Up

- Initiate discussions, take the lead
- Be proactive!
- Clarify expectations
- Share research goals and agenda



SOURCES OF CONFLICT

- Goals & Expectations
- Roles
- Methods
- Communication Style
- Relationships
- Quality
- Timing/Progress
- Resources
- Work Styles/Values
- Culture

beware of barriers to effective communication

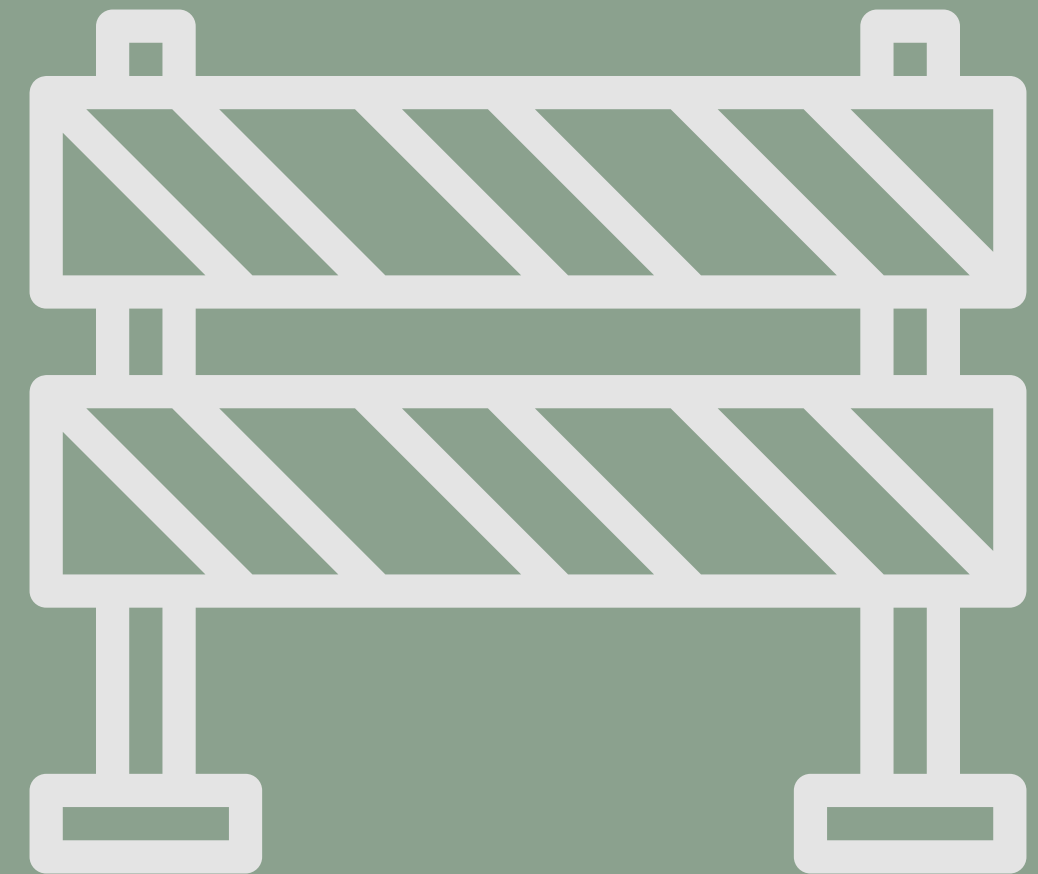
...

Unclear Language, inappropriate or misleading body language

Defensiveness or premature assumptions

Judgements based on cultural differences or interpersonal relationships

A distracting environment or sending mixed messages





By its very nature, the faculty-student relationship is not equally balanced. However, because communication is integral to the faculty-student relationship, the ability to communicate effectively is essential.

the power dynamic

- **How has your identity played a role in your interactions with faculty?**
- **What are some of the stereotypical roles/reactions in conflict situations?**
- **What are your own inhibitions when dealing with a conflict situation?**



identity roles ...

how might identity play a role?



- Negotiation skills - ability to advocate for oneself and the confidence to ask for what one wants.
- Emotions
- Imposter syndrome/Stereotype Threat
- Identity differences in conflict resolution can contribute to inequality in the workplace.

**Be curious,
not judgmental.**

- Walt Whitman/Ted Lasso

Even with different backgrounds and identities, you can develop a positive and trusting relationship through open and honest communication.

Communicating your needs



- Create opportunities for collaboration and solution-based outcomes
- You may not get 100% of what you ask for but you get 0% of what you don't ask for...
- Manage expectations for "reasonable accommodations"
- Be assertive but professional

BE ASSERTIVE: BENEFITS

Behaving assertively can help you:

- Gain self-confidence and self-esteem
- Understand and recognize your feelings
- Earn respect from others
- Improve communication
- Create win-win situations
- Improve your decision-making skills
- Create honest relationships
- Gain more job satisfaction

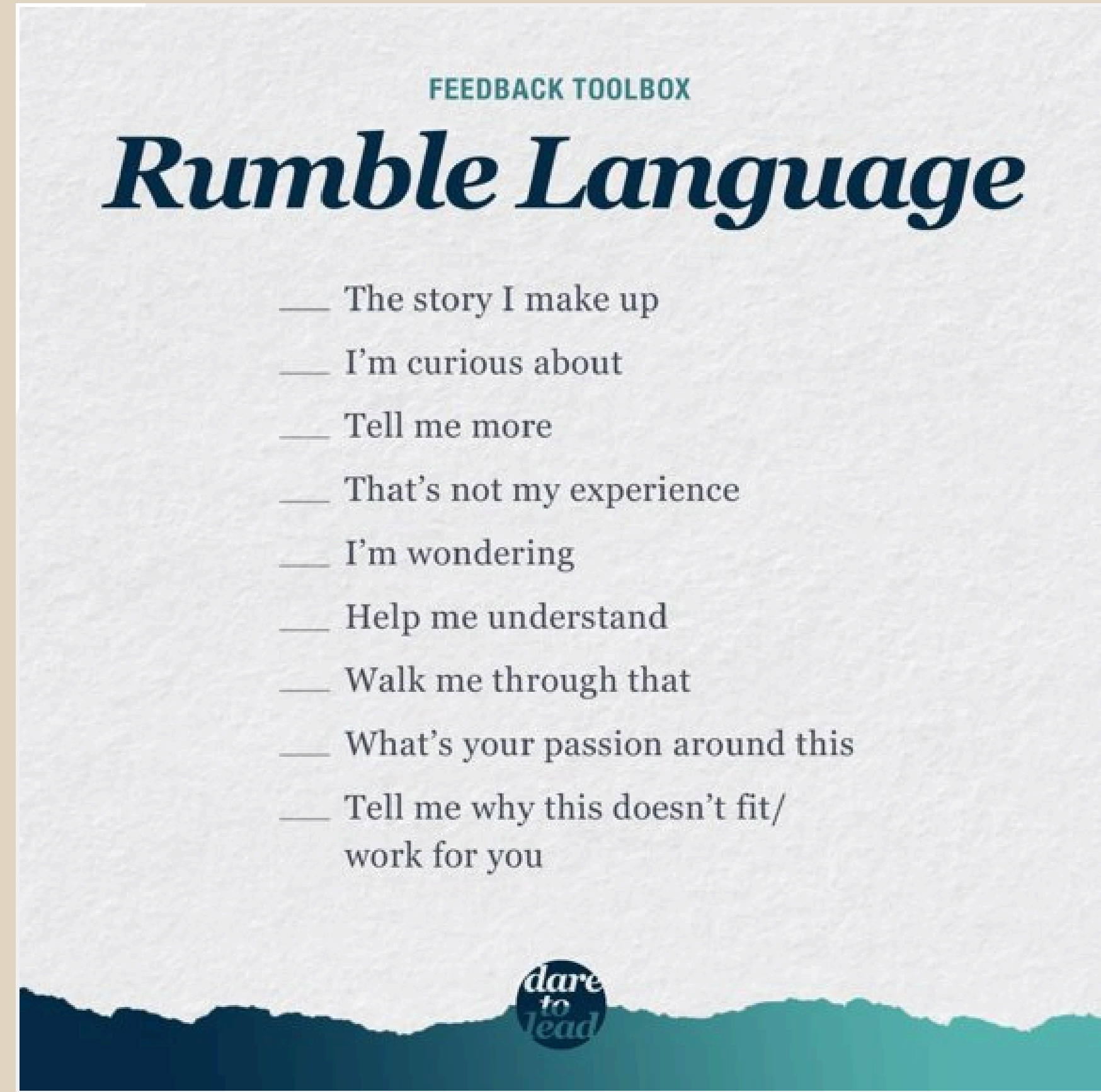
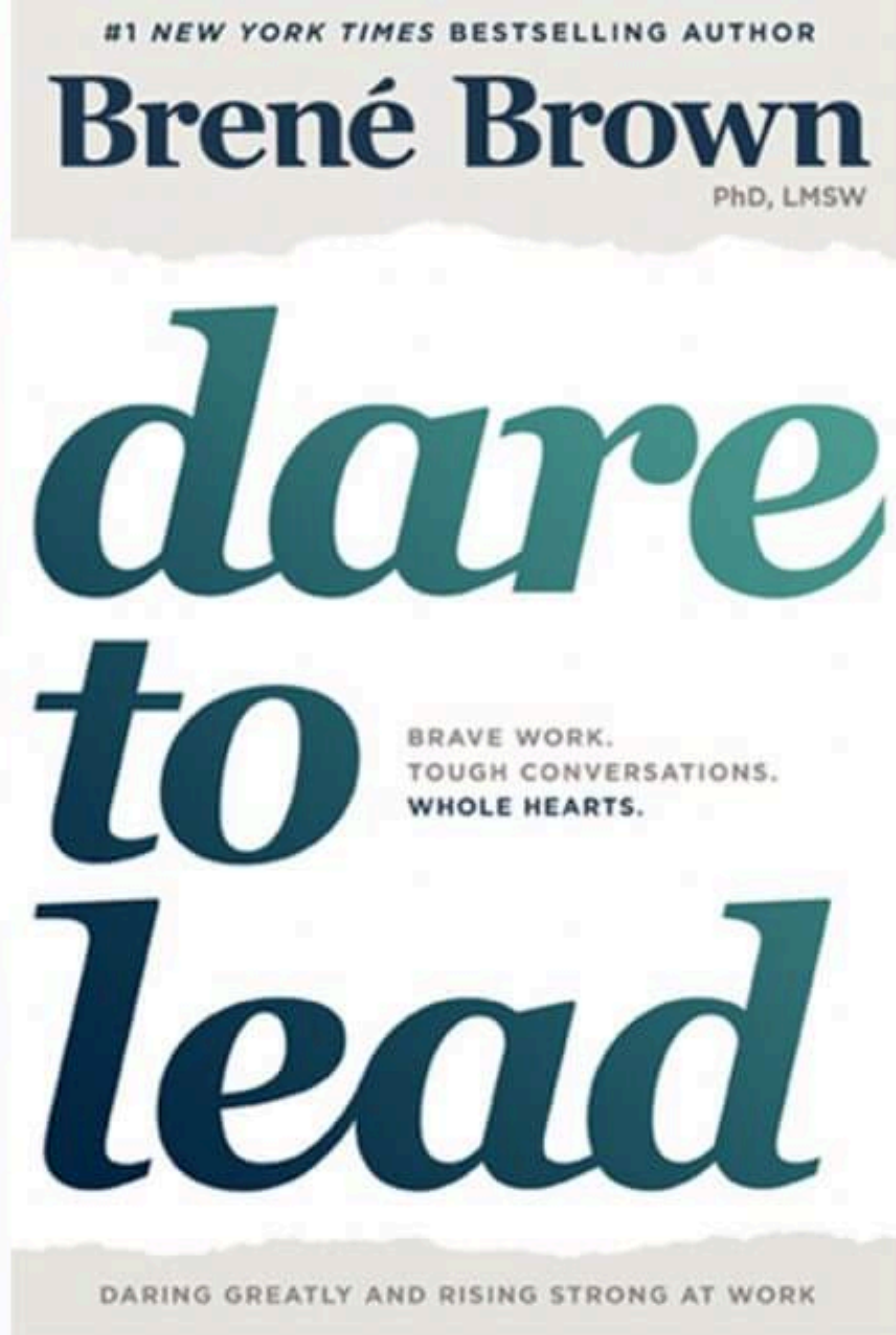
HOW TO ASSERT YOURSELF

Assertive training techniques state everyone has the right:

- To ask for what we need
- To express feelings
- To say “I don’t understand.”
- To make our own decisions and be responsible for the consequences
- To make unintentional mistakes

Important Considerations ...

- Clear and aligned expectations
- Do NOT rely on assumptions
- Look for common ground – mutual interests and values
- Good communication and conflict resolution demand vulnerability.



Peak Performance

FOR GRADUATE STUDENTS & POSTDOCS

LUNCH PROVIDED TO REGISTERED PARTICIPANTS

PERFECTIONISM & IMPOSTER SYNDROME
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 1, 2024
12:00 - 1:00 PM

MOTIVATION, MINDSET, & GOAL-SETTING
TUESDAY, OCTOBER 22, 2024
1:00 - 2:00 PM

LOCATION: THE CENTER FOR STUDENT WELLBEING CLASSROOM

REGISTER HERE:
[HTTPS://CALENDLY.COM/VU_PEAKPERFORMANCE](https://calendly.com/vu_peakperformance)



Center for Student Wellbeing
Graduate & Postdoc Academic Success



Giveaway for
first 100 students



Spend time with
VUPD Community
Canines + therapy
animals



Enjoy a coffee/tea
from the barista Cart
"Proverbial Cup"

DeStress +
Decompress

WEDNESDAY
NOVEMBER 13, 2024
4:00-6:00 PM
ALUMNI HALL



Connect with
Wellbeing &
Support
Resources



Chair massage
(first come,
first serve!)
starts at 4:00 PM



"Untangle" some
stress through art



Treat yourself to a
snack

Brought to you by The Graduate School,,
Graduate and Postdoc Academic Success,
Graduate Student Council, and
Student Care Network.

"No one belongs here more than you" – Brené Brown

If you are a VU graduate student or postdoc and would like to make an appointment with a GPAS staff member, please first review the Confidentiality & Consent form on our website, then make an appointment by scanning the qr code on the right or visiting gradschool.vanderbilt.edu/gpas

You can meet 1:1 with any GPAS staff member in Alumni Hall, Eskind Biomedical Library or via Zoom.

Make an appointment using our online calendar tool, here:
<https://calendly.com/individual-coaching-in-person-or-zoom>

